Economist at the International Monetary Fund, but also while at Chicago's Booth School of Business before I joined the RBI.

The title of this book reflects the serendipitous nature of public life. I enjoyed the give-and-take of press conferences after monetary policy meetings, especially because I knew most of the reporters. As one press conference was ending, I was asked (yet again) by a familiar face whether I was dovish like Yellen or hawkish like Volcker. I understood what the reporter was asking, but I wanted to push back on the attempt to pigeonhole me into existing stereotypes. Somewhat jokingly, I started in a James Bond-ish vein, 'My name is Raghuram Rajan…' To my horror, mid-sentence I realized I did not know how to end in a way that did not reveal more on monetary policy than I intended. So with TV cameras trained on me, I ended lamely '…and I do what I do'. For some reason, that sentence became the financial press headline the next day, with the details of our monetary policy relegated to the inside columns. The commentary on social media even reached my usually supportive daughter, who emphasized her negative reaction to my unwitting sentence with repeated thumbs-down emojis!

In a sense, though, the headline was apt. Two different governments had largely given me free rein at the Reserve Bank, reposing their trust in me. Knowing I had a three-year term, I could push hard for change. Eventually, the usual opposition from vested interests would build up, but I hoped the RBI would complete much of the needed reforms by then. And indeed it did.

I came into office during the currency crisis, when India was termed one of the Fragile Five. So my first task was stabilization. But right from the beginning, I realized that the prospect of financial sector reforms would be an aid to stabilization. With India making the transition from low-income to middle-income country, the need for these reforms was clear. Of course, reforms are an ongoing process,